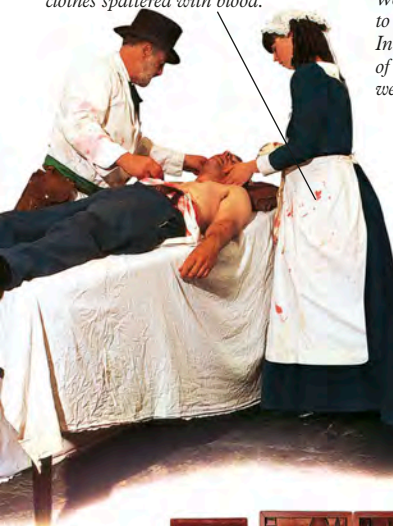


The Unionists

The soldiers of the North, or Union, wore dark blue coats or jackets and light blue trousers. They had more and better weapons than the troops from the South because most of the factories making weapons were in the North.



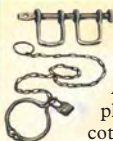
The surgeons who treated soldiers often worked with dirty hands and clothes spattered with blood.



The slave states

The wealth of the Southern states of America came from plantations producing cotton, sugar, and tobacco.

The work on the plantations was carried out by slaves—the descendants of those who had been captured and shipped over from Africa. Their masters could do what they liked with them and they were often treated badly. Slavery was finally abolished in America in 1865.



Slaves could be bought and sold at market like animals. Often families were split up.

Women volunteered to help the wounded. In the North, teams of trained nurses were set up.



Most medicines were not very effective, and a few were actually dangerous.



Special kit

With its pliers and saw, this box looks like a tool kit. In fact, it was a surgeon's case used during the American Civil War.

